

APPENDIX A*

Lemma 1 (Local Optimality): For the control system of the acupuncture robot, if the parameters in L_{sp} and vel-con are appropriately selected, there exists $w^* > 0$ such that, for all $w > w^*$, the trajectory-constrained model predictive control (TCMPC) can be equivalently transformed into a constrained linear quadratic regulator (LQR), and it holds that:

$$\mathbf{u}_k = \arg \min_{\mathbf{u} \in \mathbb{U}} w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{Tk} \mathbf{u} - \mathbf{S}_d \right\|^2 \quad (\text{A.1})$$

Proof: With trajectory tracking included as a constraint, the standard MPC problem $P_N^m(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d)$ can be defined as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} V_N^{r*}(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d) &= \min_{\delta \mathbf{u}_k, \hat{\mathbf{q}}_k} L_{Sp} \\ \text{s.t. vel-con} \quad & T_s \mathbf{J}_k \mathbf{u}_k = \mathbf{S}_d \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A.2})$$

Based on (A.2), the optimization problem can be further defined as $P_N^m(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d)$, which is expressed as:

$$\begin{aligned} V_{N,w}^{m*}(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d) &= \min_{\delta \mathbf{u}_k, \hat{\mathbf{q}}_k} L_{Sp} + w \left\| \Delta T \mathbf{J}_k \mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{S}_d \right\|_1 \\ \text{s.t. vel-con} \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A.3})$$

Building on Ref. [42], $\exists w^* > 0$, such that for any $w > w^*$, the condition $V_N^{m*}(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d) = V_N^{r*}(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d)$ holds for all variables within the feasible domain, and the following expression is obtained:

$$\mathbf{u}_k = \arg \min_{\mathbf{u} \in \mathbb{U}} w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{Tk} \mathbf{u} - \mathbf{S}_d \right\|_1 \quad (\text{A.4})$$

Let $w_2 > w_1 > w^*$. Based on the properties of convex functions, the following holds:

$$\begin{aligned} w_1 \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_k \mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{S}_d \right\|_1 &\leq w \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_k \mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{S}_d \right\|^2 \\ &\leq w_2 \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_k \mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{S}_d \right\|_1 \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A.5})$$

Therefore:

$$V_{N,w_1}^{m*}(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d) \leq V_N^{FS*}(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d) \leq V_{N,w_2}^{m*}(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d) \quad (\text{A.6})$$

Further:

$$V_N^{r*}(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d) \leq V_N^{FS*}(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d) \leq V_N^{r*}(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d) \quad (\text{A.7})$$

Therefore, $V_N^{FS*}(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d) = V_N^{r*}(\xi, \mathbf{q}_k^d)$, and it follows that:

$$\mathbf{u}_k = \arg \min_{\mathbf{u} \in \mathbb{U}} w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{Tk} \mathbf{u} - \mathbf{S}_d \right\|^2 \quad (\text{A.8})$$

Theorem 1 (Stability): For the TCMPC of the acupuncture robot, with the selection of $\mathbf{Q}$, $\mathbf{R}$, $\mathbf{P}_{TC}$, $\mathbf{V}$, and $\mathbb{Q}_c$ following Ref. [21], and given the target joint angle $\mathbf{q}_k^d$ and the target sequence $\mathbf{S}_d = [\mathbf{S}_{d1}, \mathbf{S}_{d2}, \dots, \mathbf{S}_{dn}]$ for trajectory tracking, if the final convergence direction of $\mathbf{S}_{dk}$ is aligned with $\mathbf{q}_k \rightarrow \mathbf{q}_k^d$, then:

- 1) If $\mathbf{q}_k^d \in \mathbb{Q}$ and $\mathbf{S}_d$ satisfy vel-con, the closed-loop system is asymptotically stable, and the target tracking conditions are always satisfied.
- 2) Otherwise, the closed-loop system is in an asymptotically stable state and satisfies:

$$\hat{\mathbf{q}}_k = \arg \min_{\mathbf{q} \in \mathbb{Q}} \left\| \mathbf{q} - \mathbf{q}_k^d \right\|_V^2 \quad (\text{A.9})$$

Proof: The core of the proof involves demonstrating that the optimal value of the Lyapunov function decreases after incorporating $w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{Tk} \mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{S}_d \right\|^2$. The proof strategy focuses on recursive feasibility and ξ_k convergence to 0, similar to the proof in Refs. [20][21][43]. Considering at time k , if the solution to Eq. (11) is $(\delta \mathbf{q}_{k|k}, \mathbf{q}_{k|k}, \hat{\mathbf{q}}_k^d, \delta \mathbf{u}_{\{k:k+N-1\}|k})$, then a feasible solution at time $k+1$ is $(\delta \mathbf{q}_{k+1|k}, \mathbf{q}_{k+1|k}, \hat{\mathbf{q}}_k^d, \delta \mathbf{u}_{\{k+1:k+N-1\}|k})$. $\delta \mathbf{u}_{k+N|k} = \kappa \xi_{k+N|k}$ is consistent with the definition in Ref. [21]. Substitute the feasible solution at time $k+1$ into Eq. (11). According to Refs. [21][43], there is:

$$\begin{aligned} &V_{N|k+1}^{FS*}(\xi_{k+1|k}, \delta \mathbf{u}_{\{k+1:k+N\}|k}) - V_{N|k}^{FS*}(\xi_k, \delta \mathbf{u}_{\{k:k+N-1\}|k}) \\ &\leq -\left\| \xi_{k|k} \right\|_Q^2 - \left\| \delta \mathbf{u}_{k|k} \right\|_R^2 - w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{k|k} \mathbf{u}_{k|k} - \mathbf{S}_{d|k} \right\|^2 \\ &\quad + w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{k+1|k} \mathbf{u}_{k+1|k} - \mathbf{S}_{d|k+1} \right\|^2 \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A.10})$$

When the trajectory tracking convergence direction of $\mathbf{S}_{d|k} \rightarrow \mathbf{S}_{d|k+n}$ is aligned with $\mathbf{q}_k \rightarrow \mathbf{q}_k^d$, which, in other words, the direction of trajectory tracking is consistent with the system approaching steady state, $\exists k^* > 0$, such that $\forall k > k^*$, there is:

$$\left\| \mathbf{S}_{d|k} \right\| > \left\| \mathbf{S}_{d|k+1} \right\| > \left\| \mathbf{S}_{d|k+2} \right\| > \dots \quad (\text{A.11})$$

According to optimality, there is:

$$\begin{aligned} &V_{N|k+1}^{FS*}(\xi_{k+1|k}, \delta \mathbf{u}_{\{k+1:k+N\}|k}) - V_{N|k}^{FS*}(\xi_k, \delta \mathbf{u}_{\{k:k+N-1\}|k}) \\ &\leq -\left\| \xi_{k|k} \right\|_Q^2 - \left\| \delta \mathbf{u}_{k|k} \right\|_R^2 - \min_{\mathbf{u}_k \in \mathbb{U}} w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{k|k} \mathbf{u}_{k|k} - \mathbf{S}_{d|k} \right\|^2 \\ &\quad + \min_{\mathbf{u}_{k+1} \in \mathbb{U}} w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{k+1|k} \mathbf{u}_{k+1|k+1} - \mathbf{S}_{d|k+1} \right\|^2 \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A.12})$$

If $\mathbf{S}_{d|k} / (T_s \mathbf{J}_{k|k}) \in \mathbb{U}$, then according to **Lemma 1**, the following holds:

$$T_s \mathbf{J}_{k|k} \mathbf{u}_{k|k} = \mathbf{S}_{d|k} \quad (\text{A.13})$$

Therefore:

$$\min_{\mathbf{u}_k \in \mathbb{U}} w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{k|k} \mathbf{u}_{k|k} - \mathbf{S}_{d|k} \right\|^2 = 0 \quad (\text{A.14})$$

According to (A.11), $\mathbf{S}_{d|k+1} / (T_s \mathbf{J}_{k+1|k+1}) \in \mathbb{U}$ also holds true, so:

$$\min_{\mathbf{u}_{k+1} \in \mathbb{U}} w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{k+1|k+1} \mathbf{u}_{k+1|k+1} - \mathbf{S}_{d|k+1} \right\|^2 = 0 \quad (\text{A.15})$$

If $\mathbf{S}_{d|k} / (T_s \mathbf{J}_{k|k}) \notin \mathbb{U}$, then $\min_{\mathbf{u}_k \in \mathbb{U}} w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{k|k} \mathbf{u}_{k|k} - \mathbf{S}_{d|k} \right\|^2$ represents the distance between $\mathbf{S}_{d|k}$ and the feasible domain. Based on (A.11) and **Lemma 1**, the distance between $\mathbf{S}_{d|k+1}$ and the feasible domain is less than $\mathbf{S}_{d|k}$, that is:

$$\begin{aligned} &\min_{\mathbf{u}_k \in \mathbb{U}} w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{k|k} \mathbf{u}_{k|k} - \mathbf{S}_{d|k} \right\|^2 \\ &> \min_{\mathbf{u}_{k+1} \in \mathbb{U}} w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{k+1|k+1} \mathbf{u}_{k+1|k+1} - \mathbf{S}_{d|k+1} \right\|^2 \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A.16})$$

In summary, the following inequality always holds true under the assumption:

1. ^{*} https://github.com/RPCDLT-SYSU/AcuRobot/modeling_and_control/TC_appendix.pdf

$$\begin{aligned}
& -\min_{\mathbf{u}_k \in \mathcal{U}} w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{k|k} \mathbf{u}_{k|k} - \mathbf{S}_{d|k} \right\|^2 \\
& + \min_{\mathbf{u}_{k+1} \in \mathcal{U}} w \cdot \left\| T_s \mathbf{J}_{k+1|k+1} \mathbf{u}_{k+1|k+1} - \mathbf{S}_{d|k+1} \right\|^2 \leq 0
\end{aligned} \quad (\text{A.17})$$

Consequently:

$$\begin{aligned}
& V_{N|k+1}^{FS*}(\xi_{k+1|k}, \delta \mathbf{u}_{[k+1:k+N]|k}) \\
& - V_{N|k}^{FS*}(\xi_{k|k}, \delta \mathbf{u}_{[k:k+N-1]|k}) < 0
\end{aligned} \quad (\text{A.18})$$

Equation (A.18) holds true for $\forall k > k^*$, thus concluding the proof of **Theorem 1**.

APPENDIX B

The control method using Eq. (9) to track the same right-angle trajectories shows significant dependence on the segmentation tracking precision and exhibits poor adaptability to different trajectories. Setting the initial point to (45, 97, 67) mm and extracting target points 1 and 2, with segmentation

intervals of 5 mm, 15 mm, and 50 mm, and joint angle error thresholds for segmentation switches set to 1e-1, 1e-2, and 1e-3, respectively, the corresponding simulation results are shown in **Fig. B.1**. It can be observed that segmentation precision affects the differences of $\mathbf{q}_k^d$ between segments. When the higher segmentation precision is required, the switching threshold needs to be set to a reasonably small value, but it should not be too small, otherwise, switching to the next segment will be impossible. Conversely, with lower segmentation precision, the switching threshold should be set to a reasonably large value. Additionally, the controller shows poor adaptability to different tracking trajectories. The optimal parameters for tracking trajectory 1 perform poorly for tracking trajectory 2. In summary, without explicitly incorporating Cartesian trajectory tracking constraints, the control method based on Eq. (9) exhibits extremely poor robustness for tracking specific trajectories of the acupuncture robot.

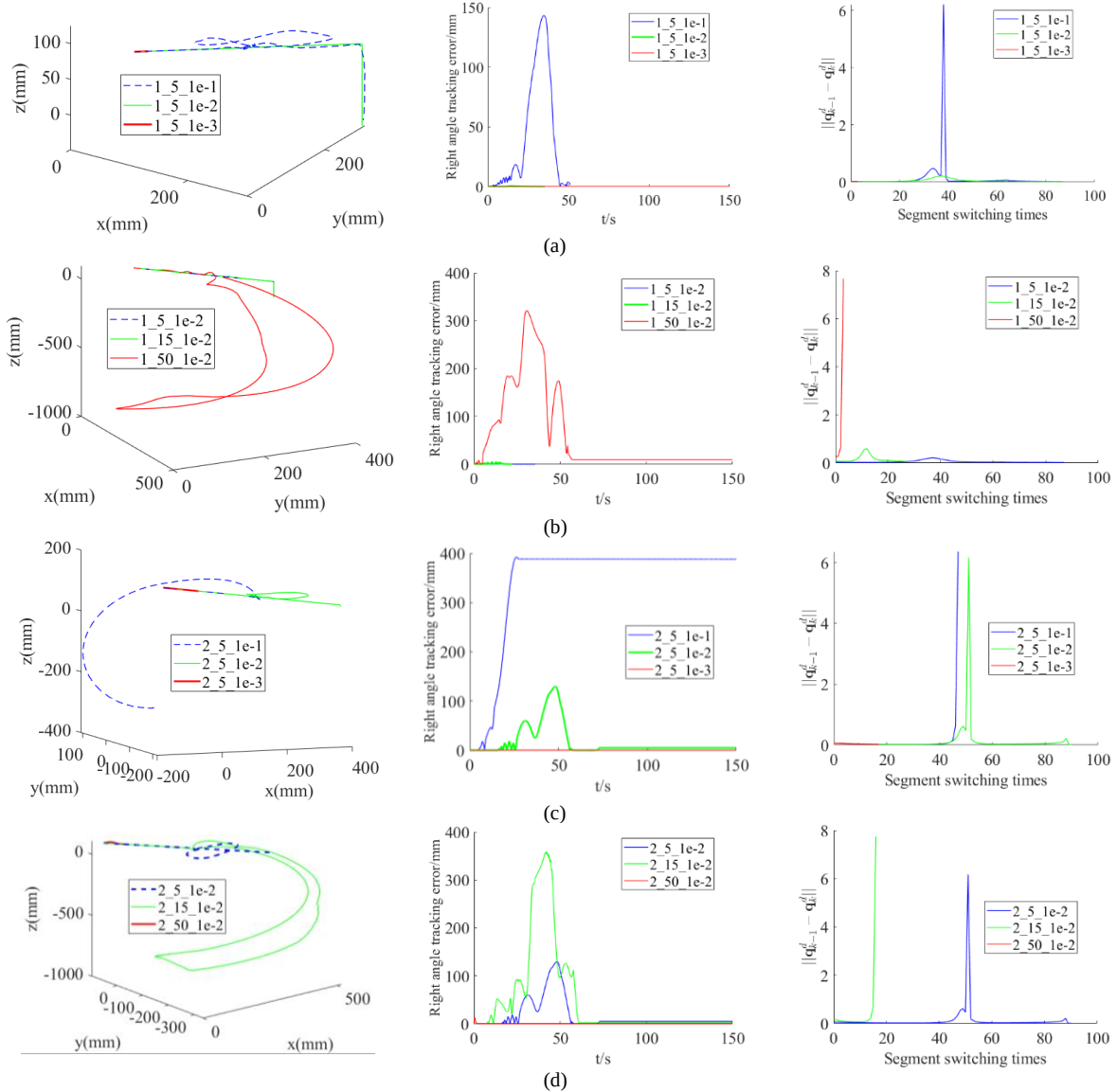


Fig. B.1 Tracking results of traditional MPC method. (a) Comparison of target 1 with segment 5mm and different switching thresholds. (b) Comparison of target 1 with switching threshold 1e-2 and different segments. (c) Comparison of target 2 with segment 5mm and different switching thresholds. (d) Comparison of target 2 with switching threshold 1e-2 and different segments.

Algorithm C.1 Right angle trajectory tracking method with dual camera acupoint location

Input: P_0, P_k - initial and current end point, ${}^{G_c}O, {}^{L_c}O$ - acupoint located by global camera and hand-eye camera, O - acupoint from the last control sequence, ϵ_2 - section switching threshold, q_{k-1}, q_k - joint angle at the last and current control sequence, u_{k-1} - joint velocity at the last control sequence, flag - label of the right angle section

Output: u_k - joint velocity of the current control sequence, P_0 - updated initial end point, O - updated acupoint, flag

```

if  ${}^{L_c}O$  is not none
     $O \leftarrow {}^{L_c}O$  ;
else if  ${}^{G_c}O$  is not none
     $O \leftarrow {}^{G_c}O$  ;
end
 $q_k^d \leftarrow$  (5) and (3) with  $O$  ;
if  $\|P(x, y, z) - W(x, y, z)\|_2 < \epsilon_2$  and flag is 1
    Switch tracking section of the right-angle trajectory with flag  $\leftarrow 0$ 
if  $\|P(x, y) - O(x, y)\| > \epsilon_2$  and flag is 0
    Restart the trajectory tracking with  $P_0(x, y, z) \leftarrow P(x, y, z)$  and
    flag  $\leftarrow 1$ ;
     $W(x, y, z) \leftarrow [O(x), O(y), P(z)]^T$  ;
if flag is 1
     $P_h = \text{Projection}(P, \overline{P_0 W})$  ;
     $S_d \leftarrow$  (14), (16) and (17) with  $P_h, P_0, W$  ;
else
     $P_v = \text{Projection}(P, \overline{TO})$  ,
     $S_d \leftarrow$  (15), (16) and (17) with  $P_v, P_0, W$  ;
end
 $u_k \leftarrow$  (18) with  $q_k^d, q_{k-1}, q_k, u_{k-1}$  and  $S_d$ 
return  $u_k, P_0, O$ 

```

Algorithm C.2 Sphere trajectory tracking method with force-bending perception

Input: P - center of the sphere, P' - tracking point, $\hat{F}_s$ - force vector, r - sphere radius, q_{k-1}, q_k - joint angle at the last and current control sequence, u_{k-1} - joint velocity at the last control sequence

Output: u_k - joint velocity of the current control sequence

$${}^0p_H \leftarrow (19) \sim (23) \text{ with } P, P', \hat{F}_s \text{ and } r$$

Bending aware through $\theta \leftarrow \arccos\left(\frac{\overline{PP'} \cdot \overline{PH}}{\|PP'\| \|PH\|}\right)$ with P, P' and

$0p_H$

$$q_k^d \leftarrow (24) \sim (25) \text{ with } \theta \text{ and } {}^0p_H$$

Project P' to its sphere point $P'_r \leftarrow (26)$ with P, P' and r

$$S_d \leftarrow (27) \sim (28) \text{ with } P'_r, P', {}^0p_H, \theta \text{ and } r$$

$$u_k \leftarrow (29) \text{ with } q_{k-1}, q_k, u_{k-1}, q_k^d \text{ and } S_d$$

return u_k

APPENDIX C

The detailed implementation of the trajectory planning and tracking control method based on multiple sensor perception is shown in the following algorithm, with **Algorithm C.1**

correspond to the rough positioning stage and **Algorithm C.2** correspond to the accurate positioning stage.

APPENDIX D

In the experimental system, the D-H parameters of the 8-DOF robot are shown in **TABLE D.1**.

TABLE D.1 The DH parameter of the 8-DOF AcuRobot

Joint	$\theta / ^\circ$	d / mm	a / mm	$\alpha / ^\circ$	Variable boundary
1	q_1	192.5	0	90	$[-360, 360] / ^\circ$
2	$q_2 + 90$	0	266	180	$[-135, 135] / ^\circ$
3	$q_3 + 90$	0	0	90	$[-150, 150] / ^\circ$
4	q_4	324	0	-90	$[-360, 360] / ^\circ$
5	q_5	0	0	90	$[-147, 147] / ^\circ$
6	q_6	155	0	0	$[-360, 360] / ^\circ$
7	0	$q_7 + 45$	0	0	$[0, 50] \text{ mm}$
8	q_8	250	36.12	0	$[-360, 360] / ^\circ$

APPENDIX E

Different bending situations of the needle under different environment and position circumstances are explored. The bending degree and orientation with the corresponding ${}^E F_s$ are shown in **Fig. E.1**.

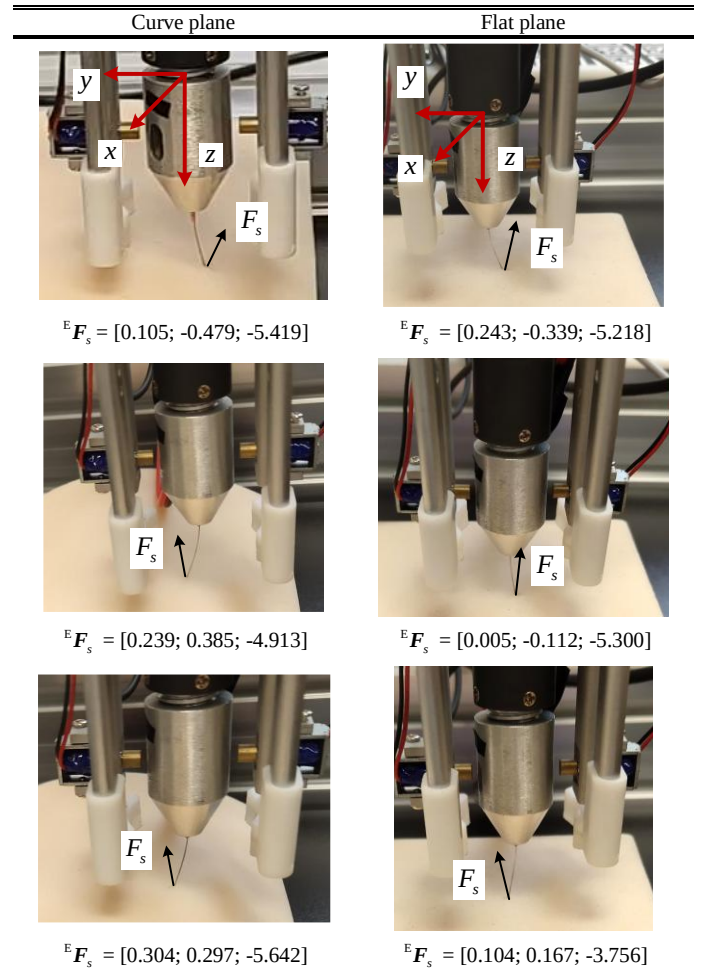


Fig. E.1 Force and bending degree of needle tip on flat and curved tissues

APPENDIX F

In this section, the detailed adaptive adjustment scheme for environmental parameters and the control gain selection are presented.

The predicted external force is:

$$\hat{F}_e = \begin{cases} \hat{K}_e(x_m - \hat{x}_e) + \hat{B}_e\dot{x}_m & : x_m \geq \hat{x}_e \\ 0 & : x_m < \hat{x}_e \end{cases} \quad (\text{F.1})$$

The error between the predicted and the actual force is:

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{F}_e - F_e &= \hat{K}_e(x_m - \hat{x}_e) + \hat{B}_e\dot{x}_m - K_e(x_m - x_e) - B_e\dot{x}_m \\ &= [x_m \quad -1 \quad \dot{x}_m] \phi \end{aligned} \quad (\text{F.2})$$

where, $\phi = [\hat{K}_e - K_e \quad \hat{K}_e\hat{x}_e - K_ex_e \quad \hat{B}_e - B_e]^T$.

Define the Lyapunov function as:

$$V = \phi^T \Gamma \phi \quad (\text{F.3})$$

where, $\Gamma \in \mathbb{R}^{3 \times 3}$ is a positive definite symmetric matrix.

According to Ref. [38], define $\dot{\phi}$ as:

$$\dot{\phi} = -\Gamma^{-1} \begin{bmatrix} x_m \\ -1 \\ \dot{x}_m \end{bmatrix} (\hat{F}_e - F_e) \quad (\text{F.4})$$

Differentiate (F.3) with respect to ϕ and combine with (F.2) to obtain:

$$\dot{V} = 2\phi^T \Gamma \dot{\phi} = -2\phi^T \begin{bmatrix} x_m \\ -1 \\ \dot{x}_m \end{bmatrix} (\hat{F}_e - F_e) = -2(\hat{F}_e - F_e)^2 \quad (\text{F.5})$$

When $\dot{\phi}$ is designed according to (F.4), $\dot{V} < 0$ always holds true. That is, when $t \rightarrow \infty$, $\phi \rightarrow 0$ and $\hat{F}_e \rightarrow F_e$.

Furthermore, based on (F.4), it follows that:

$$\dot{\hat{K}}_e = -\gamma_1 x_m (\hat{F}_e - F_e) \quad (\text{F.6})$$

$$\dot{\hat{x}}_e = \frac{(\hat{F}_e - F_e)}{\hat{K}_e} (\gamma_1 x_m \hat{x}_e + \gamma_2) \quad (\text{F.7})$$

$$\dot{\hat{B}}_e = -\gamma_3 \dot{x}_m (\hat{F}_e - F_e) \quad (\text{F.8})$$

where γ_1 , γ_2 and γ_3 are positive scalars.

Combined with (F.2), (F.4), (F.6), (F.7) and (F.8), the dynamics corresponding to the adaptive update rates can be expressed as:

$$\dot{\phi} = - \begin{bmatrix} \gamma_1 x_m^2 & -\gamma_1 x_m & \gamma_1 x_m \dot{x}_m \\ -\gamma_2 x_m & \gamma_2 & -\gamma_2 \dot{x}_m \\ \gamma_3 x_m \dot{x}_m & -\gamma_3 \dot{x}_m & \gamma_3 \dot{x}_m^2 \end{bmatrix} \phi \quad (\text{F.9})$$

The dynamics presented in (F.9) indicates that the system's dynamic response also depends on x_m and $\dot{x}_m$. Typically, based on the environmental model setting in Eq. (49), assume $x_m = 4$, $\dot{x}_m = 2$ (which nearly corresponds to the condition when F_e exceeds $F_{\max} = 5N$, necessitating a switch to force-tracking mode, as shown in Fig. 8). Using the set control gain settings $\gamma_1 = 5$, $\gamma_2 = 10$, $\gamma_3 = 0.5$ and substituting these values into (F.9), the dominant pole of the system is calculated to be -92 (with the value of other two poles negligible). The absolute

value of this dominant pole is significantly greater than the dominant pole -48.7 of the transfer function corresponding to Eq. (37), where the input is $X_r(s)$ and the output is $\Delta F(s)$:

$$\Delta F(s) = \frac{K_e k_F + B_e s k_F}{s + k_F + K_e k_F G(s) + B_e s k_F G(s)} X_r(s) \quad (\text{F.10})$$

It demonstrates that the selected control gain settings ensure a faster update rate for the environmental parameters estimation compared to that of the force tracking by modeling the reference trajectory as Eq. (39).

To further investigate the effect of control gains, the control gains are set to be high $\gamma_1 = 150$, $\gamma_2 = 100$, $\gamma_3 = 5$ and low $\gamma_1 = 1$, $\gamma_2 = 2$, $\gamma_3 = 0.1$, respectively. The polynomial function described in Eq. (51) was tracked. The results are presented in Fig. F.1.

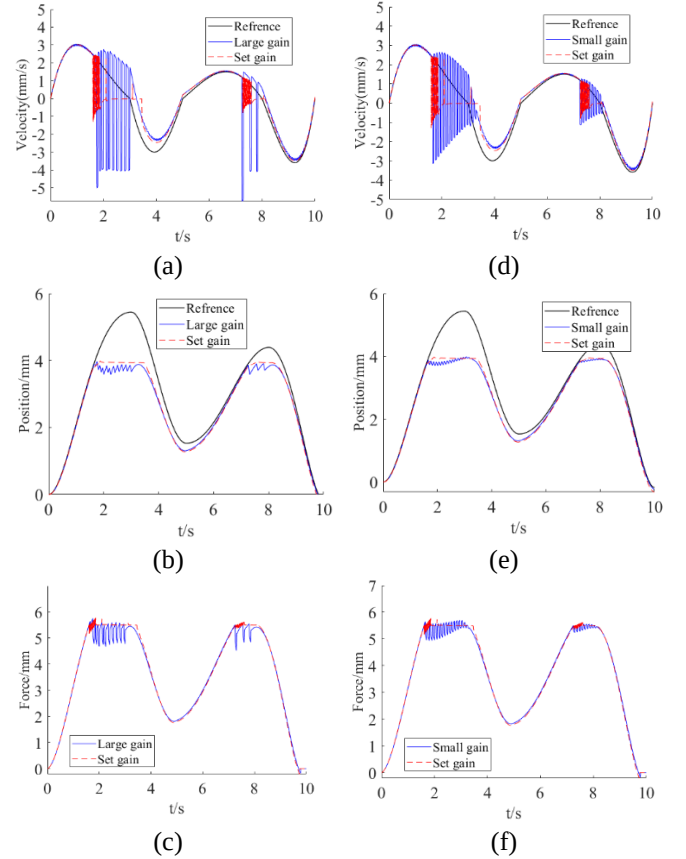


Fig. F.1. Comparison of velocity tracking and force control performance between large gains ((a) ~ (c)), low gains ((d)~(f)) and the set control gains.

From Fig. F.1 (a)~(c), it can be observed that the extreme high control gain settings result into system response chatters to guarantee the system stable margin and increase high-frequency oscillations. Therefore, the control gain cannot be set too large, especially considering the motor load will reach saturation (maximum speed is limited) and the actual control delay is high. From Fig. F.1 (d)~(f), it can be observed that the low control gains exacerbate the system's low-frequency oscillations, leading to poorer force tracking performance.

Overall, the selection of control gains was determined through simulation and experimental tuning while ensuring the stability margins are met. Therefore, our selected control gain settings fall within the optimal range, balancing response speed and oscillations.